

GS-3

READYMADE INTRODUCTIONS & CONCLUSIONS

- ➔ UPSC-READY TONE WITH TAGLINES, YOJANAS & SDG
- ➔ CRISP LATEST EXAMPLES TO ENRICH AND UPDATE
- ➔ THEMATIC, IMPACTFUL CONCLUSION
- ➔ SMARTLY STRUCTURED FOR QUICK REVISION

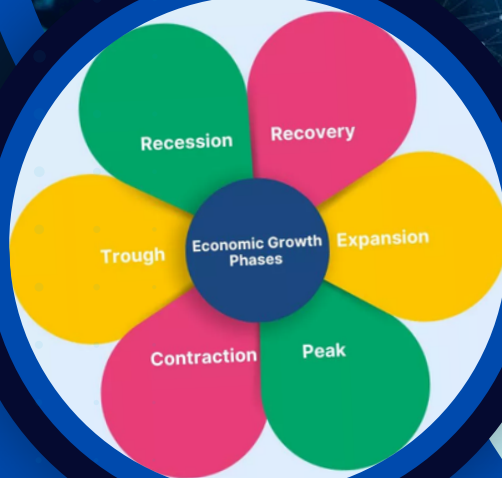
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GS-3: Readymade Introductions & Conclusions**Why This Compilation?**

- 1.**UPSC-Oriented Tone:** Tailored introductions & conclusions to match the analytical depth expected in GS-3 Mains answers.
- 2.**Saves Time:** Direct plug-in content for mains no need to brainstorm on-spot.
- 3.**Structured & Thematic:** Every sub-topic follows a consistent structure - Quote ► Introduction ► Current Examples ► Conclusion.
- 4.**Includes Schemes, Taglines, Reports:** Boosts content richness with real-time data, catchy phrases & SDG linkages.
- 5.**Ready for Last-Minute Revisions:** Designed to be your end-moment reference sheet before writing the exam.

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GS-3 THEMATIC BREAKDOWN**1. Indian Economy & Inclusive Development****Sub-Themes:**

- Planning & Economic Strategy in India
- Resource Mobilization: Taxation, Capital Markets, FDI, FPI
- Growth vs Development: Indicators, HDI, Inequality
- Employment: Informal Sector, Gig Economy, Unemployment Types
- Inclusive Growth: JAM Trinity, Direct Benefit Transfers, Financial Inclusion
- Role of SHGs, Cooperatives, MUDRA, PM-SVANidhi, Skill Development
- NITI Aayog strategy papers and Viksit Bharat 2047 vision

2. Budgeting, Fiscal Management & Investment Models**Sub-Themes:**

- Budget Process: Types, Components, Fiscal Deficit, FRBM Act
- Revenue & Capital Expenditure Trends
- Government Schemes vs Capital Creation
- Outcome Budgeting, Performance-Based Budgeting
- Investment Models: PPP, Hybrid Annuity Model (HAM), BOT, EPC
- Disinvestment Policy and Monetization Pipelines
- Central & State Budget Interface

3. Agriculture & Allied Sector**Sub-Themes:**

- Major Crops & Cropping Patterns across Agro-climatic Zones
- Irrigation: Types, PMKSY, Watershed Development
- Agri Marketing: eNAM, APMC reforms, GrAMs
- Post-Harvest Infrastructure: Cold Chains, Logistics, Warehousing
- Animal Rearing: Dairy, Fisheries, Livestock Economics
- MSP, Farm Subsidies, Input Support Schemes
- Food Security: PDS, Buffer Stocks, NFSA
- Agri-Tech: Drone Technology, Kisan Drones, AI in Farming

4. Food Processing & Rural Industry**Sub-Themes:**

- Scope & Significance of Food Processing in Rural Economy
- Pradhan Mantri Kisan SAMPADA Yojana
- Supply Chain Management & Logistics
- Upstream & Downstream Linkages
- Challenges: Cold Chain Gaps, Licensing, Finance Access
- FPOs & Agri Startups

5. Land Reforms & Rural Transformation**Sub-Themes:**

- Zamindari Abolition, Tenancy Reforms, Land Ceiling Acts
- Digital Land Records (SVAMITVA, DILRMP)
- Land Leasing Reforms
- Agrarian Structure & Farmer Ownership
- Urbanisation & Land Use Policy

6. Industrial Growth & Economic Reforms**Sub-Themes:**

- LPG Reforms (1991 & Beyond)
- Make in India, Start-Up India, Industrial Corridors
- MSME Sector Reforms & Credit Support
- Ease of Doing Business, Insolvency Code, Production Linked Incentives (PLI)
- FDI/FII Trends, Sectoral Caps, Trade Policies

7. Infrastructure Development**Sub-Themes:**

- Transport: Bharatmala, Sagarmala, Gati Shakti
- Energy Infrastructure: Solar, Wind, Green Hydrogen, National Electricity Policy
- Railways Modernisation & Airports Development
- Urban Infra: Smart Cities, AMRUT, Affordable Housing
- Logistics, Digital Infra, PMGSY

8. Science, Technology & Innovation**Sub-Themes:**

- S&T Applications: Defence, Health, Education, Energy
- Indigenous Innovations: DRDO, ISRO, CSIR Contributions
- Indigenisation of Technology

- Role of Research Institutes, Startups & Private Sector in R&D
- Government Policies: National R&D Policy, STI Policy

9. Information Technology & Emerging Tech

Sub-Themes:

- AI, IoT, Blockchain, Big Data, Quantum Computing
- National Data Governance Policy, IndiaAI Mission
- IT in Governance: Digital India, DBT, e-Governance
- Cybersecurity: CERT-In, Digital Personal Data Protection Act
- IPR Issues, Data Localisation, Deep Tech Regulation

10. Environment, Biodiversity & Climate Change

Sub-Themes:

- Conservation: Biodiversity Acts, Wildlife Corridors, Biosphere Reserves
- Climate Agreements: UNFCCC, COPs, INDCs, Paris Deal, LiFE Mission
- Pollution: Air, Water, Soil — CPCB Reports, NCAP
- EIA, CRZ Regulations, Eco-Sensitive Zones
- Role of Tribunals: NGT, Forest Rights Act
- Forest Cover Reports, CAMPA Funds

11. Disaster Management

Sub-Themes:

- Types of Disasters: Natural & Man-Made
- NDMA Guidelines, Sendai Framework
- Early Warning Systems, Cyclone Shelters, Heatwave Plans
- Role of Armed Forces, NDRF, Civil Society
- Post-Disaster Recovery & Resilience Building

12. Internal Security & Challenges

Sub-Themes:

- Border Security & Insurgency: NE, J&K, LWE Areas
- Communication Networks: Role in Propaganda, Surveillance
- Cybersecurity: Attacks, CERT-In, National Cyber Coordination Centre
- Role of Media & Social Media: Regulation, Misinformation
- Money Laundering: PMLA, ED, Shell Companies
- Organised Crime-Terror Nexus
- Coordination among CAPFs, IB, State Forces

Topic 1 of GS-3 (Indian Economy: Planning, Mobilization, Growth, Employment)

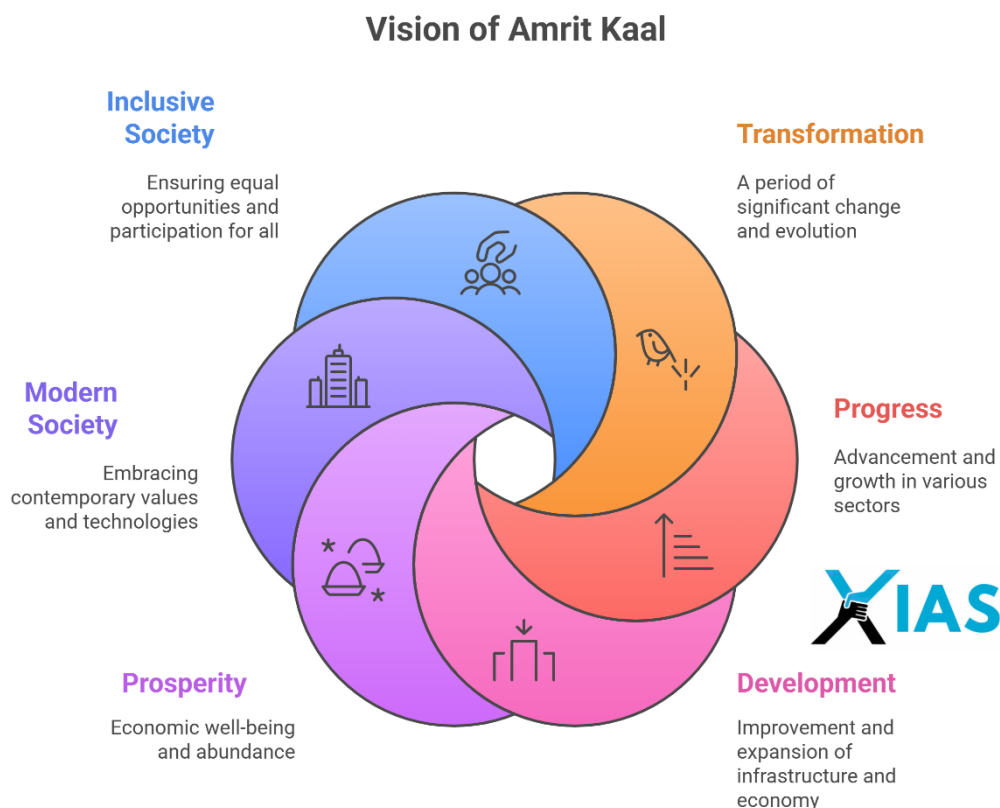
1. Planning & Economic Strategy in India

Quote:

"A vision without a plan is just a wish." – Narendra Modi

Introduction:

India's journey from **centralised Five-Year Plans** to **Viksit Bharat@2047** reflects a shift towards **mission-mode governance** and **competitive federalism**, guided by NITI Aayog's reform-driven think tank model and "Sabka Prayas" philosophy.



Examples:

1. NITI Aayog released sector-specific strategy papers aligned with Viksit Bharat goals.
2. State governments were ranked under **SDG India Index**, promoting outcome-based planning.
3. Finance Commission incentivised states using performance-linked grants.

Conclusion:

Strategic planning must align **vision with execution**, ensuring economic reforms are **federal, future-ready, and inclusive**, building a roadmap for Amrit Kaal.

2. Resource Mobilization: Taxation, Capital Markets, FDI, FPI

Quote:

"Revenue is the lifeblood of a government, transparency its heartbeat." — Inspired by the Kelkar Committee

Introduction:

With **Make in India**, **Invest India**, and **Digital India** as facilitators, India aims to boost **resource mobilisation** through **efficient taxation**, deepened **capital markets**, and stable **foreign investments**.

Examples:

1. **Faceless tax regime** and Vivad Se Vishwas scheme improved tax compliance.

2. **SEBI** rolled out T+0 trade settlement to boost market liquidity.
3. **FDI** norms liberalised in **space, semiconductor**, and **green energy** sectors.

Conclusion:

A dynamic resource mobilisation strategy ensures **fiscal strength**, attracts global trust, and powers the engine of **inclusive and self-reliant growth**.

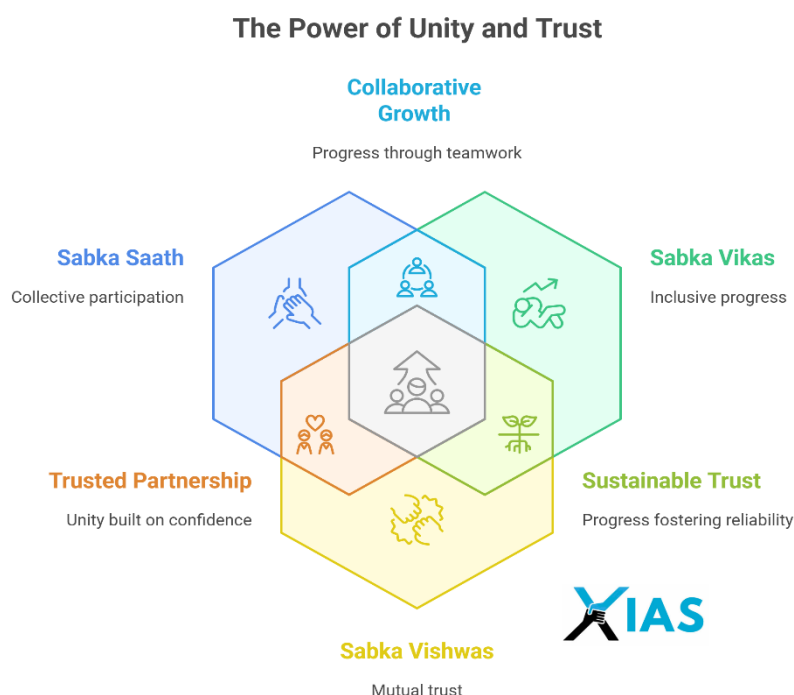
3. Growth vs Development: Indicators, HDI, Inequality

Quote:

"Growth is hollow if it doesn't bridge the divide." — Inspired by the Human Development Report

Introduction:

India's development narrative balances **GDP growth** with improvement in **HDI**, **GDI**, and **Multidimensional Poverty Index**, reflecting the push toward "**Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas**".



Examples:

1. NITI Aayog released updated **MPI report** identifying high-deprivation districts.
2. Government focused on **Aspirational Districts Programme** for equitable outcomes.
3. UNDP data showed progress in **life expectancy and schooling years**.

Conclusion:

India must prioritise **inclusive indicators** alongside GDP to ensure growth transforms into **real, measurable and people-centric development**.

4. Employment: Informal Sector, Gig Economy, Unemployment Types

Quote:

"Employment is not just about income—it's about identity and dignity." — World Bank

Introduction:

In the world's youngest nation, addressing **structural unemployment** and formalising the **gig and informal economy** is key to leveraging the **demographic dividend** and building "**Atmanirbhar Bharat**".

Examples:

1. **e-Shram** portal enrolled over 29 crore unorganised workers.
2. **NITI Aayog's gig report** recommended social security for platform workers.

3. **PLFS** flagged high urban unemployment and low female LFPR.

Conclusion:

India's employment strategy must go beyond numbers to ensure **dignified, secure and future-ready livelihoods** across sectors and skill levels.

5. Inclusive Growth: JAM Trinity, DBT, Financial Inclusion

Quote:

"JAM is the highway to equity in a digital India." — Economic Survey

Introduction:

Inclusive growth is driven by **JAM Trinity**, **Direct Benefit Transfers**, and **Jan Dhan–Aadhaar–Mobile synergy**, making entitlements **portable, paperless, and person-centric**, aligned with **SDG 1 & 10**.

Examples:

1. **DBT** transferred ₹30 lakh crore+ across 400+ schemes directly into beneficiaries' accounts.
2. **PM Jan Dhan Yojana** crossed 50 crore bank accounts milestone.
3. **UPI** transactions surpassed ₹18 lakh crore monthly, promoting digital access.

Conclusion:

India's model of digital inclusion proves that **technology + trust = transformation**—a mantra for bridging developmental divides.

6. Role of SHGs, Cooperatives, MUDRA, PM-SVANidhi, Skill Development

Quote:

"Self-help is the best help—especially when it builds an economy from below." — Inspired by grassroots movements

Introduction:

Schemes like **MUDRA**, **PM-SVANidhi**, and **DAY-NRLM** empower **SHGs, nano-enterprises**, and informal vendors, becoming catalysts of **"Vocal for Local"** and **"Empower the last mile first"**.

Examples:

1. **MUDRA loans** crossed ₹23 lakh crore mark, majority to women & SC/STs.
2. **PM-SVANidhi** onboarded over 70 lakh street vendors with microcredit and e-KYC.
3. **Skill India Mission** trained over 1.5 crore youth under PMKVY 4.0.

Conclusion:

People-led micro-entrepreneurship is India's answer to **inclusive capitalism**, unlocking **dignity, credit and capacity** at the grassroots.

7. NITI Aayog Strategy Papers and Viksit Bharat@2047 Vision

Quote:

"What India does today will shape the world of tomorrow." — Viksit Bharat Vision

Introduction:

Viksit Bharat@2047 envisions a **prosperous, inclusive and climate-smart India**, guided by **NITI Aayog's thematic roadmaps**, aligning national ambitions with **SDG 2030 and India@100** goals.

Examples:

1. Sectoral Viksit Bharat targets released for MSMEs, health, and innovation.
2. NITI Aayog launched policy dialogues with states on export hubs and skilling.
3. Paper on energy transitions laid roadmap for Net Zero by 2070.

Conclusion:

Strategic visioning must translate into **cohesive policy, cooperative execution, and catalytic change**—making India a global model of development by 2047.

2. Budgeting, Fiscal Management & Investment Models

1. Budget Process: Types, Components, Fiscal Deficit, FRBM Act

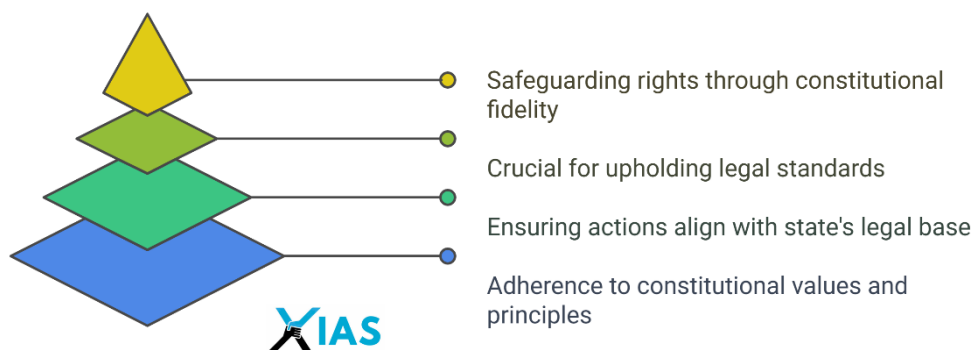
Quote

"A budget is not just numbers on a page, it is an embodiment of our values." – Barack Obama

Intro

India's budget process reflects both **constitutional fidelity (Article 112)** and developmental foresight, structured around estimates, receipts, and expenditures. Guided by the **FRBM Act**, it aims to ensure macroeconomic stability while "**planning prosperity through prudence.**"

Constitutional Fidelity Pyramid



Examples

- Interim budget focused heavily on **revenue expenditure**.
- Fiscal deficit projected around **5.1%** due to high subsidies.
- **16th Finance Commission** asked to review **FRBM targets**.

Conclusion

A **calibrated fiscal framework** with an **independent fiscal council** can balance growth imperatives with discipline.

2. Revenue & Capital Expenditure Trends

Quote

"Capital expenditure is the soul of sustainable growth."

Intro

India's fiscal strategy is undergoing a shift **from revenue-heavy budgets to capex-led growth engines**, in line with the aim of "**spending less and building more.**" This approach enhances productivity, infrastructure, and private investment.

Examples

- Capex allocation increased to over **₹11 lakh crore** for infra.
- Fertilizer and food subsidies kept **revenue outgo** elevated.
- PM Gati Shakti got enhanced **capital infusion** for logistics.

Conclusion

Capex focus must continue, coupled with **efficient monitoring** to ensure long-term returns and fiscal resilience.

3. Government Schemes vs Capital Creation

Quote

"Schemes must not just spend, they must build."

Intro

Welfare schemes must increasingly focus on **productive asset creation**, aligning with the government's **"Minimum Government, Maximum Governance"** philosophy. Capital-linked welfare ensures both inclusion and economic expansion.

Examples

- **Jal Jeevan Mission** built lasting rural infrastructure.
- **PM Awas Yojana-Urban** spurred housing-linked capex.
- Rationalized **MGNREGS** outlay redirected toward durable assets.

Conclusion

Linking welfare with **long-term capital assets** ensures **economic multipliers without fiscal stress**.

4. Outcome Budgeting & Performance-Based Budgeting

Quote

"You can't manage what you can't measure." – Peter Drucker

Intro

India's budgeting is evolving to measure impact, not just inputs—**"from outlay to outcome"**. By integrating **performance-based indicators**, it enhances transparency and public accountability.

Examples

- **PMAY dashboard** tracks unit-wise completion status.
- Ministries like **Rural Development** linked funds to measurable outputs.
- **NITI Aayog's Performance Index** shapes fund allocations.

Conclusion

Mainstreaming **real-time tracking** and **performance-linked disbursal** can ensure outcomes match allocations.

5. Investment Models: PPP, HAM, BOT, EPC

Quote

"Public-private synergy builds more than infrastructure—it builds trust."

Intro

India's infra push is increasingly led by hybrid models like **PPP, HAM, BOT, and EPC**, helping mitigate financial risk. These models reflect the philosophy of **"collaborative growth through shared responsibility."**

Examples

- **Bharatmala highways** built using HAM and EPC mix.
- **Solar parks** leveraged PPP with Viability Gap Funding.
- **Vande Bharat** trains procured under innovative PPP format.

Conclusion

Improving **risk-sharing frameworks** and **speedy dispute resolution** will rejuvenate private investment in infra.

6. Disinvestment Policy & Monetization Pipelines

Quote

"The government has no business to be in business." – NITI Aayog Vision Document

Intro

Strategic disinvestment and asset monetization help the state exit non-core sectors while unlocking capital. Through **"funding the future without expanding deficits,"** these tools enhance fiscal space.



Examples

- **IDBI Bank** saw progress on strategic disinvestment.
- NMP monetized **brownfield assets** in highways and power.
- **LIC IPO** broadened retail access to public wealth.

Conclusion

A transparent, time-bound disinvestment policy is key to efficiency and capital mobilization.

7. Central & State Budget Interface

Quote

"Cooperative federalism must reflect in cooperative fiscalism."

Intro

The effectiveness of India's public finance depends on **centre-state fiscal synergy**, where "**collaborative spending powers**" ensure harmonized development. The Union budget now increasingly incentivizes state-level capital creation.

Examples

- **50-year interest-free loans** offered to states for infra projects.
- **GST compensation adjustments** aided states' fiscal balance.
- **PM Gati Shakti** involves coordinated planning across levels.

Conclusion

A robust **intergovernmental fiscal framework** is vital for equitable, outcome-driven development across states.

Theme 3: Agriculture & Allied Sector

1. Major Crops & Cropping Patterns across Agro-climatic Zones

Quote

"Agriculture is not just a means of livelihood, it's the backbone of Bharat."

Intro

India's cropping patterns reflect its **diverse agro-climatic zones**, but are increasingly misaligned with water and soil sustainability. A shift toward "**agro-ecological planning for nutritional security**" is now crucial.

Examples

- Paddy area in Punjab reduced, replaced by **maize and pulses** under diversification schemes.
- **Millet cultivation** surged in dry zones following the **International Year of Millets** push.
- **Oilseed promotion** expanded in arid zones through targeted cluster development.

Conclusion

Cropping choices must align with **climate, soil, and market linkages** to ensure resilient and sustainable agriculture.



2. Irrigation: Types, PMKSY, Watershed Development

Quote

"More crop per drop is not just a slogan, it's a necessity."

Intro

Efficient irrigation is the fulcrum of Indian agriculture. With only about **50% of gross cropped area irrigated**, schemes like **PMKSY and watershed development** aim to bridge the "irrigation inclusion gap."

Examples

- **Micro-irrigation coverage** expanded under PMKSY-Per Drop More Crop.
- Watershed Development Component aided **drought-proofing** in Bundelkhand.
- **Solar-powered pumps** introduced under KUSUM for off-grid irrigation.

Conclusion

Scaling up **micro and climate-resilient irrigation** must be priority, with **tech-driven water budgeting** at the local level.

3. Agri Marketing: eNAM, APMC reforms, GrAMs

Quote

"Farmer incomes rise not just from what they grow, but how and where they sell."

Intro

Agricultural marketing reforms are vital to move from **price support to price realization**. Initiatives like **e-NAM, Model APMC Acts, and GrAMs** aim to create a "One Nation, One Market" ecosystem.

Examples

- Over **1,400 mandis** integrated with e-NAM to enable inter-state trade.
- States like **Madhya Pradesh** adopted APMC Act reforms for private markets.
- **GrAMs** operationalized with digital kiosks and warehousing linkages.

Conclusion

India needs a **unified agri-market architecture** with robust logistics, digital access, and transparent pricing mechanisms.

4. Post-Harvest Infrastructure: Cold Chains, Logistics, Warehousing

Quote

"A farm's true value is realized only after the harvest."

Intro

India loses nearly **15-20% of its agri produce post-harvest**, due to gaps in cold chains and logistics. Addressing this is key to achieving "farm to fork efficiency."

Examples

- **Mega Food Parks** received fresh capital under PMFME for cold storage and processing.
- **ONDC integration** piloted for direct farm-to-retail logistics.
- NABARD supported **warehouse projects** through agri infra funds.

Conclusion

Post-harvest infrastructure must be **localized, tech-integrated**, and aligned with farmer producer organizations.



5. Animal Rearing: Dairy, Fisheries, Livestock Economics

Quote

"The strength of rural India lies beyond crops—in hooves, fins, and wings."

Intro

Animal husbandry, contributing over **30% to agri-GVA**, is key for **income diversification and nutritional security**. The focus is now on building **"blue, white, and pink revolutions 2.0."**

Examples

- **Dairy cooperatives** digitally modernized under Rashtriya Gokul Mission.
- **PM Matsya Sampada Yojana** scaled fishery clusters in coastal belts.
- Livestock insurance cover expanded in high-risk states through **NLM**.

Conclusion

Strengthening **value chains, veterinary access**, and insurance is vital for a **vibrant allied agri-economy**.

6. MSP, Farm Subsidies, Input Support Schemes

Quote

"MSP is not a price, it's a promise of protection."

Intro

Input subsidies and MSP offer a **safety net for farmers**, yet their **fiscal sustainability and crop bias** raise concerns. Reforms must ensure **"support without distortion."**

Examples

- MSP declared for 23 crops, but **procurement skewed toward paddy-wheat**.
- **PM-KISAN** transferred direct cash support to over 11 crore farmers.
- Fertilizer subsidy revised to **nutrient-based model** with DBT pilot.

Conclusion

Subsidies must evolve into **targeted, direct support**, linked to **crop diversification and soil health**.

7. Food Security: PDS, Buffer Stocks, NFSA

Quote

"No one should go hungry in the land that grows food."

Intro

India's food security architecture—centered on **NFSA, PDS, and buffer norms**—ensures inclusive access. Yet, leakages and overstocking challenge the vision of **"hunger-free, waste-free Bharat."**

Examples

- **One Nation One Ration Card** achieved full portability across states.
- PDS digitization reduced ghost beneficiaries in high-leakage districts.
- Buffer stock norms recalibrated for seasonal and climate shocks.

Conclusion

Reforming PDS via **tech, Aadhaar, and community audit** can ensure efficient, demand-based food security.

8. Agri-Tech: Drone Technology, Kisan Drones, AI in Farming

Quote

"From bullock carts to drones—Indian farming is flying into the future."

Intro

Emerging technologies like **Kisan drones, AI, and precision farming** are driving the transition toward **"smart agriculture."** These tools enhance productivity, reduce input misuse, and empower farmers.

Examples

- **Kisan Drones** used in over 80,000 hectares for pesticide spraying.
- Agri-stack pilots launched for **farm-level data-driven advisories**.
- AI-based soil sensors deployed in clusters under **Digital Agriculture Mission**.

Conclusion

Scaling **affordable, vernacular, and accessible agri-tech** is essential for inclusive, future-ready farming.

Theme 4: Food Processing & Rural Industry

1. Food Processing in Rural Economy

Quote

"Turning grain into gain—food processing multiplies farm value."

Intro

Food processing is the **missing link between farms and formal markets**, with the potential to double farmer incomes, generate rural jobs, and curb wastage. It strengthens the **"value from the village"** model through local entrepreneurship.

Examples

- Food processing sector contributes over **10% to manufacturing GVA**.
- Mega Food Parks created **over 60,000 rural jobs** directly.
- Rise in demand for **processed millets and organic produce** boosted rural enterprise.

Conclusion

Unlocking the sector's potential requires **rural-centric industrial policy** and **skill-linked infrastructure**.

2. Pradhan Mantri Kisan SAMPADA Yojana

Quote

"From field to factory to fork—SAMPADA builds the bridge."

Intro

The **PM Kisan SAMPADA Yojana** aims to build a robust processing ecosystem by promoting **value addition, cluster-based growth**, and reducing agri-waste. It reflects the spirit of **"processing-led prosperity."**

Examples

- Financial assistance extended to **over 900 processing units** across states.
- Agro Processing Clusters approved in **Maharashtra and Assam**.
- Waste reduction of up to **10–15%** reported in targeted zones.

Conclusion

To scale impact, the scheme must focus on **ease of credit, backward linkages**, and export integration.

3. Supply Chain Management & Logistics

Quote

"A strong supply chain is the artery of agro-industrial India."

Intro

Efficient logistics—from farm gate to processing hub—is essential to minimize spoilage and ensure quality.

"From surplus to seamless" must be the approach in managing agri supply chains.

Examples

- **ONDC integrated farmer produce** with retail logistics networks.
- Railways launched **Kisan Rails** for faster perishables transport.
- NABARD-funded logistics hubs supported FPO-led aggregation.

Conclusion

Integrated **cold-logistics and multimodal supply networks** are critical to powering rural industrialization.

4. Upstream & Downstream Linkages

Quote

"The strength of a food economy lies in its entire chain, not just one link."

Intro

Effective upstream and downstream linkages connect **producers to processors and processors to markets**. Such connections foster a **"farm-to-factory-to-market" continuum** that multiplies rural incomes.

Examples

- **Agri export hubs** created downstream tie-ups with global retailers.
- Farmer groups linked to **Mega Food Parks** via primary collection centres.
- Startups used blockchain for **traceable supply chain assurance**.

Conclusion

Strengthening **last-mile aggregation and first-mile distribution** is vital to a competitive rural value chain.

5. Challenges: Cold Chain Gaps, Licensing, Finance Access

Quote

"An unprocessed crop is an opportunity lost."

Intro

Cold chain gaps, complex licensing, and weak finance access limit rural processing. Tackling these hurdles is key to enabling a **"farm-to-fork without friction"** ecosystem.

Examples

- FSSAI eased **compliance norms** for micro food enterprises.
- Cold chain availability still less than **15% of demand** in perishables.
- Credit support under **CGTMSE** expanded for agri-processing units.

Conclusion

Streamlined regulations, **customized rural finance**, and targeted infra support can unlock sectoral growth.

6. FPOs & Agri Startups

Quote

"From marginal farmers to market makers—FPOs are rural India's startups."

Intro

FPOs and agri startups empower smallholders by enhancing bargaining power, market access, and scale. They reflect the shift toward **"cooperative enterprise for competitive advantage."**

Examples

- Over **10,000 FPOs registered** under the Central Sector Scheme.
- Startups like **Agrowave** and **DeHaat** built end-to-end digital platforms.
- FPOs in Bihar and MP entered **contract farming for organic exports**.

Conclusion

A supportive policy and digital ecosystem can make FPOs and startups the **backbone of rural industrial revival**.

Theme 5: Land Reforms & Rural Transformation

1. Zamindari Abolition, Tenancy Reforms, Land Ceiling Acts

Quote

"The land question is the heart of rural justice."

Intro

Land reforms like **zamindari abolition, tenancy regulation, and ceiling limits** were designed to democratize land ownership and **"redistribute dignity"** in rural India. Yet, implementation gaps persist in several states.

Examples

- Land ceiling redistribution remains below **2% of net sown area** nationally.
- **Tenancy laws updated** in Odisha and UP to legalize sharecropping.
- Land rights regularization for **forest dwellers** implemented in tribal belts.

Conclusion

Future reforms must balance **social equity with agricultural viability**, focusing on legal clarity and inclusiveness.

2. Digital Land Records (SVAMITVA, DILRMP)

Quote

"Jo zameen ka malik, wahi vikas ka adhikari."

Intro

Digitalizing land records through **SVAMITVA and DILRMP** enhances **ownership, dispute resolution, and rural credit flow**, aligning with the vision of **"smart villages with secure titles."**

Examples

- Over **2 crore rural property cards** issued under SVAMITVA.
- States like Karnataka and Maharashtra fully digitized land records.
- **GIS mapping** used to resolve multi-party claims in hilly regions.

Conclusion

To sustain momentum, India must ensure **interoperable, tamper-proof, and citizen-friendly** land records systems.

3. Land Leasing Reforms**Quote**

"Unrecorded tenancies breed insecurity; formal leasing fosters productivity."

Intro

Modern land leasing frameworks aim to protect both landowners and cultivators, promoting **"ownership without alienation."** States are moving toward **Model Land Leasing Act-inspired reforms**.

Examples

- **Model Land Leasing policies** adopted in Andhra Pradesh and Uttarakhand.
- Digitized lease records enabled **credit access to sharecroppers**.
- Pilot leases included **climate clauses** for crop failure risk-sharing.

Conclusion

India needs a **uniform, flexible, and legally secure** leasing framework to unlock land productivity.

4. Agrarian Structure & Farmer Ownership**Quote**

"True empowerment is tilling your own land with your own rights."

Intro

India's agrarian structure dominated by **small and marginal holdings** poses challenges to scale and investment. Empowering farmers through **land ownership and collective models** is key to rural transformation.

Examples

- Over **86% of landholdings** now belong to small and marginal farmers.
- SHG federations began **community farming on pooled land** in Kerala.
- Joint land titles under **PMAY-Gramin** improved women's land access.

Conclusion

A shift toward **secure tenure, group farming**, and women's land rights can transform the rural landscape.

5. Urbanisation & Land Use Policy**Quote**

"Land is not just for farming—it's the foundation of rural futures."

Intro

Urbanisation pressures are altering rural land use patterns. A **balanced, zoned, and inclusive** land use policy must anchor rural growth to the idea of **"planned prosperity."**

Examples

- **National Geo-Spatial Policy** enabled rural land use planning tools.
- States like Gujarat adopted **village land use zoning** for agro-processing clusters.
- Land banks set up for **Urban clusters and MSME hubs**.

Planned Prosperity Strategy

**Conclusion**

India must ensure **smart land-use planning** that preserves agri-ecosystems while catalyzing rural industrialization.

Theme 6. Industrial Growth & Economic Reforms**1. LPG Reforms (1991 & Beyond)****Quote**

"Economic reforms begin where control ends."

Intro

The **LPG reforms transformed India** from a closed, socialist economy to a competitive market-led one. They laid the foundation for **India@100 as a developed nation**, promoting global integration and sectoral liberalisation.

Examples

- Post-reform period saw **GDP growth averaging above 6%** for decades.
- Industrial licensing abolished in **nearly all sectors**.
- **Services exports became a major growth driver**, led by IT and finance.

Conclusion

Future progress must combine **reform continuity with inclusive safety nets** to widen the benefits of liberalisation.

2. Make in India, Start-Up India, Industrial Corridors**Quote**

"India must become the factory of the world without losing its soul."

Intro

Schemes like **Make in India**, **Start-Up India**, and **industrial corridors** aim to boost domestic manufacturing, jobs, and innovation by building a “**production-driven, globally integrated India**.”

Examples

- Over **1.4 lakh startups** recognized, creating **employment across 700+ districts**.
- **Mobile manufacturing exports** crossed ₹1.2 lakh crore.
- **DMIC and other corridors** operationalised with smart infrastructure nodes.

Conclusion

A push for **design-led, tech-integrated industrialisation** will future-proof India's production base.

3. MSME Sector Reforms & Credit Support

Quote

"Small businesses build big economies."

Intro

The **MSME sector**, employing over **11 crore people**, is pivotal for inclusive industrial growth. Initiatives like **Emergency Credit Line**, **Udyam portal**, and **Credit Guarantee Schemes** aim to enable “**formal strength from informal roots**.”

Examples

- ₹3.6 lakh crore disbursed under **ECLGS** to 1.2 crore MSMEs.
- **Udyam Assist Platform** onboarded over 2 crore micro enterprises.
- **SIDBI** launched **digitised loan pipelines** for small-scale units.

Conclusion

Targeted credit, **digital skilling**, and **cluster competitiveness** can unlock MSME-led growth momentum.

4. Ease of Doing Business, Insolvency Code, PLI

Quote

"From red tape to red carpet is a journey of mindset and law."

Intro

Improving the **ease of doing business** through reforms like the **Insolvency & Bankruptcy Code**, **PLI schemes**, and **faceless approvals** reflects the shift to a “**compliance-light, trust-heavy**” economy.

Examples

- **IBC** enabled recovery of **₹2.9 lakh crore** in major insolvency cases.
- **PLI schemes across 14 sectors** attracted investment and scaled exports.
- **MCA21, GSTN**, and single-window clearances boosted **regulatory transparency**.

Conclusion

India must deepen reforms in **contract enforcement** and **informal sector inclusion** for holistic ease.

5. FDI/FII Trends, Sectoral Caps, Trade Policies

Quote

"Capital follows clarity, consistency, and confidence."

Intro

India's evolving **FDI and trade policies**, coupled with improved ease of doing business, aim to harness “**trust reshoring**” and make India a **key node in global value chains**.

Examples

- India received **\$80+ billion FDI**, led by renewables, electronics, and services.
- Sectoral caps liberalised in **insurance (74%)** and **defence (74%)**.
- India signed **FTA pacts with UAE and Australia** for export market access.

Conclusion

A balance of **open markets** and **strategic safeguards** is vital for resilient industrial expansion.

Theme 7: Infrastructure Development

1. Transport: Bharatmala, Sagarmala, Gati Shakti

Quote

"Infrastructure is the foundation stone of a nation's economic destiny."

Intro

Through **Bharatmala, Sagarmala**, and the **PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan**, India is creating unified transport systems and reducing logistics bottlenecks—marking a decisive shift toward a **"One Nation, One Infrastructure"** paradigm for integrated growth.

Examples

- **35+ logistics parks** approved under Bharatmala Phase-I.
- **Gati Shakti portal** digitally monitors 2,000+ infra projects.
- Sagarmala enabled **port-linked clusters** in coastal regions.

Conclusion

Accelerating **multimodal infrastructure with digital governance** will unlock seamless connectivity and regional equity.

2. Energy Infrastructure: Solar, Wind, Green Hydrogen, NEP

Quote

"Clean energy isn't a luxury, it's a national imperative."

Intro

India is transforming into a **Green Growth Leader** by investing in renewables, battery storage, and **green hydrogen**, aligning infrastructure with the **Panchamrit climate targets** and a **Net-Zero 2070 vision**.

Examples

- Solar capacity surpassed **80 GW**, among the world's top 5.
- Green Hydrogen Mission targets **5 MMT production with ₹20,000+ crore support**.
- **Hybrid RE parks** launched in Gujarat and Rajasthan.

Conclusion

Stable policy, **storage infrastructure**, and green finance are key to achieving clean energy security.

3. Railways Modernisation & Airports

Development

Quote

"Speed and sustainability are the twin engines of modern mobility."

Intro

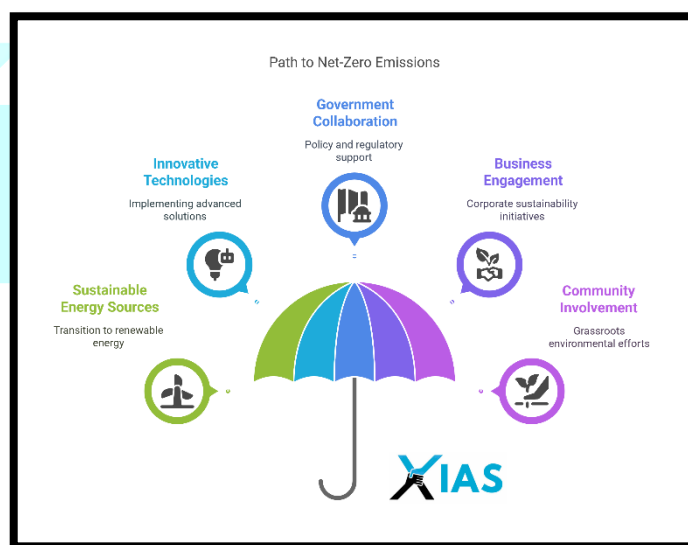
Rail and air networks are being reimagined under **Vande Bharat, UDAN**, and the **Amrit Bharat Station Scheme**, embodying the **Amrit Kaal infrastructure push** for **fast, green and inclusive mobility solutions**.

Examples

- **60+ Vande Bharat trains** deployed on major routes.
- **500+ stations** under Amrit Bharat redevelopment plan.
- **480+ air routes** opened under UDAN.

Conclusion

Smart design and affordability should guide the mobility transition across Bharat and India.



4. Urban Infra: Smart Cities, AMRUT, Affordable Housing

Quote

"Well-planned cities are not built overnight—they are coded into policy and design."

Intro

Urban renewal through **Smart Cities Mission**, **AMRUT 2.0**, and **PMAY-Urban** reflects India's effort to build **climate-resilient, tech-enabled and inclusive cities**, consistent with the aspiration of **India@100** as a sustainable urban civilisation.

Examples

- **7,000+ smart infrastructure projects** executed under Smart Cities.
- **500+ cities** achieving water tap coverage via AMRUT.
- Over **1.3 crore houses sanctioned** under PMAY-U.

Conclusion

A citizen-first approach and **climate-smart design** will shape the next generation of Indian cities.

5. Logistics, Digital Infra, PMGSY

Quote

"Connectivity is productivity in the Bharat of today."

Intro

From **PMGSY rural roads** to **Digital India fibre backbones** and the **National Logistics Policy**, India is building last-mile assets that reduce costs and bridge the rural-urban divide—driving the vision of a **"Viksit Bharat powered by seamless access."**

Examples

- PMGSY built over **7.5 lakh km** of all-weather rural roads.
- **2.1 lakh Gram Panchayats** connected via BharatNet.
- NLP targets **logistics cost reduction to 8–10% of GDP**.

Conclusion

Synchronising **physical and digital infrastructure** is crucial for inclusive economic transformation.

Theme 8. Science, Technology & Innovation

1. S&T Applications: Defence, Health, Education, Energy

Quote

"Science is not only a tool for discovery—it is a lever for national development."

Intro

India is strategically applying science in sectors like **defence, healthcare, education, and energy** to empower governance and citizen services—building a **"Techade-ready Bharat"** that aligns knowledge with national priorities.

Examples

- **i-Drone platform** deployed for vaccine delivery in remote areas.
- **BrahMos-NG** and indigenous radar systems enhanced defence self-reliance.
- AI-based models integrated into **DIKSHA** and **NPTEL** platforms.

Conclusion

Cross-sector innovation and **citizen-centric applications** are key to democratising scientific progress.

2. Indigenous Innovations: DRDO, ISRO, CSIR Contributions

Quote

"Aatmanirbharta in science is the cornerstone of strategic autonomy."

Intro

Institutions like **DRDO, ISRO, and CSIR** are steering India toward **indigenous R&D ecosystems**, with

innovations that serve both security and societal missions—reflecting a shift to “**lab-to-field**” excellence for **self-reliant India**.

Examples

- DRDO unveiled **Agni-5 MIRV missile** for credible deterrence.
- ISRO launched **INSAT-3DS** for advanced meteorological data.
- CSIR developed **bio-based nanofertilizers** for sustainable farming.

Conclusion

Strengthening institutional synergy and **tech-commercial linkages** will boost India’s global scientific standing.

3. Indigenisation of Technology

Quote

"Innovation isn't just imitation with delay—it is ownership with intent."

Intro

From semiconductors to defence platforms, India is accelerating **tech indigenisation** through Make in India, **Strategic Technology Boards**, and FDI-linked innovation hubs—aligning with the vision of “**design in India, for the world.**”

Examples

- India approved **semiconductor fabs** with \$10B outlay under Digital India push.
- Indigenous LoRa-based chips deployed in **IoT agriculture pilots**.
- **Tejas Mk-1A fighter jets** cleared for production by HAL.

Conclusion

Robust IP ecosystems and **domestic capacity-building** are vital for genuine tech sovereignty.

4. Role of Research Institutes, Startups & Private Sector in R&D

Quote

"The next trillion-dollar ideas will come from India's labs and lanes."

Intro

With **STEM talent abundance** and policy boosters like **Startup India** and **Anusandhan NRF**, India is mobilising academia, private capital, and grassroots startups to transform into a “**global R&D powerhouse by 2047.**”

Examples

- **National Quantum Mission hubs** launched at IISER, IITs.
- Over **1000 DeepTech startups** supported via DST-BIRAC accelerators.
- Private labs contributed to **mRNA and AI diagnostics** in public health.

Conclusion

Creating a **risk-tolerant, innovation-friendly ecosystem** is essential to sustain long-term R&D momentum.

5. Government Policies: National R&D Policy, STI Policy

Quote

"Good science needs great policy to thrive."

Intro

India’s evolving **STI Policy**, **National R&D Policy**, and budgetary prioritisation reflect a commitment to **science-led governance**, with a push toward “**Jan Bhagidari in Innovation**” and equity in research opportunities.

Examples

- **STIP 2020 draft** promotes inclusivity and open-access platforms.
- Allocation for **R&D in clean energy** doubled under Union Budget.
- **Innovation Clusters** launched under State S&T councils.

Conclusion

Forward-looking R&D policy must blend **public accountability and private agility** to deliver real-world impact.

Theme 9. Information Technology & Emerging Tech

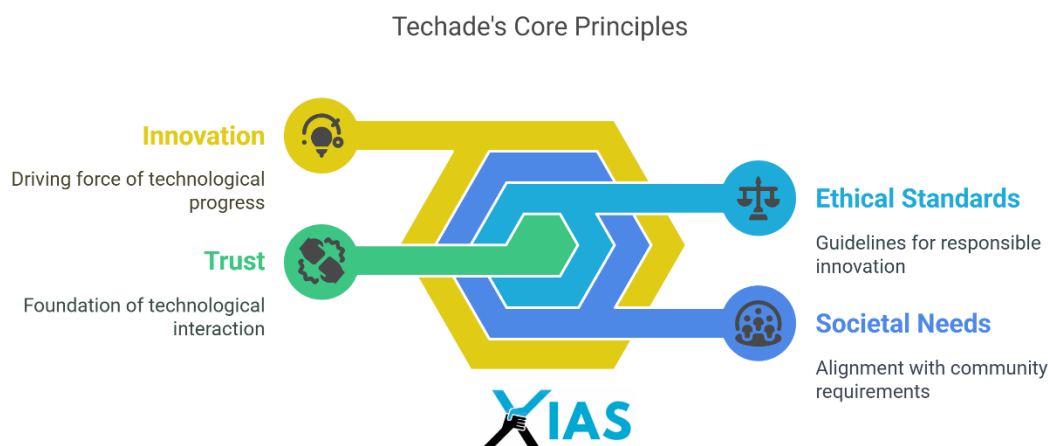
1. AI, IoT, Blockchain, Big Data, Quantum Computing

Quote

"Emerging tech is the infrastructure of the invisible."

Intro

India is leveraging **AI, IoT, Blockchain and Quantum** to catalyse next-gen governance and innovation—marking the shift to a **"Techade of Trust and Transformation"**, where data drives delivery and inclusion.



Examples

- **IndiaAI Mission** launched with ₹10,000 crore outlay.
- **Quantum Simulator** unveiled at IISc for research access.
- **IoT sensors** used in Jal Jeevan Mission for real-time monitoring.

Conclusion

Scalable pilots and **ethical frameworks** must anchor India's leap into emerging tech leadership.

2. National Data Governance Policy, IndiaAI Mission

Quote

"Data is the new oil—if governed, not spilled."

Intro

With policies like the **National Data Governance Framework** and **IndiaAI**, India aims to democratise datasets while ensuring privacy building a **"Digital Democracy with Responsible Intelligence."**

Examples

- Launch of **India Datasets Platform** for open innovation.
- **AI Centres of Excellence** approved in Tier-II cities.
- Data anonymisation protocols piloted for health analytics.

Conclusion

Balancing **open access with secure boundaries** is key to harnessing India's digital capital.

3. IT in Governance: Digital India, DBT, e-Governance

Quote

"When governance becomes digital, dignity becomes universal."

Intro

Through **Digital India**, **DBT**, and e-Gov platforms like **UMANG**, India is making governance **faceless, paperless and cashless**—ensuring “**minimum government, maximum governance**” becomes a lived reality.

Examples

- ₹30+ lakh crore transferred via DBT to over 90 crore beneficiaries.
- **DigiLocker** enabled 230+ crore document issuances.
- 1300+ services integrated under **UMANG app**.

Conclusion

Interoperability and **citizen trust** must remain central as digital public infrastructure expands.

4. Cybersecurity: CERT-In, Digital Personal Data Protection Act

Quote

"A secure cyberspace is non-negotiable in a digital republic."

Intro

The **CERT-In directives** and **Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDPA)** signify India's resolve to safeguard digital sovereignty, anchoring the vision of a “**cyber-resilient Bharat**” amid rising global threats.

Examples

- Mandatory breach reporting within **6 hours** under CERT-In norms.
- DPDPA established **Data Fiduciary & Principal** framework.
- **Cyber Surakshit Bharat** trained 300+ officers in data governance.

Conclusion

India must ensure **capacity-building and compliance** to make data protection both enforceable and equitable.

5. IPR Issues, Data Localisation, Deep Tech Regulation

Quote

"Innovation without regulation is chaos; regulation without trust is paralysis."

Intro

India is refining its **IPR, localisation, and deep tech frameworks** to protect creators and ensure safe innovation crafting a “**sandbox governance model**” fit for AI, blockchain and future tech frontiers.

Examples

- India climbed into the **top 40 of Global Innovation Index**.
- **Data localisation norms** enforced for fintech and health apps.
- DeepTech Task Force formed under DPIIT for policy roadmap.

Conclusion

Agile regulations, **global alignment and innovation autonomy** must co-exist to future-proof India's digital rise.

Theme 10. Environment, Biodiversity & Climate Change

1. Conservation: Biodiversity Acts, Wildlife Corridors, Biosphere Reserves

Quote

"We do not inherit the Earth from our ancestors; we borrow it from our children."

Intro

India's approach to conservation through **Wildlife Protection (Amendment) Act**, eco-sensitive zones, and **corridor connectivity** reflects a shift to “**coexistence over conflict**”—a foundational ethic in its ecological governance.

Examples

- **98+ Eco-Sensitive Zones** notified around protected areas.
- **Project Cheetah** rewilded species after 70+ years of extinction.
- **Kaziranga landscape project** links riverine and forest corridors.

Conclusion

Conservation must blend **community stewardship and scientific planning** for lasting biodiversity gains.

2. Climate Agreements: UNFCCC, COPs, INDCs, Paris Deal, LiFE Mission

Quote

"Climate action is not charity—it is enlightened self-interest."

Intro

India's **Panchamrit pledges**, participation in **COPs**, and the launch of the **LiFE Mission** signal a pivot to **"pro-planet lifestyles"** and equitable climate diplomacy rooted in **climate justice for the Global South**.

Examples

- India co-led the **International Solar Alliance** and **CEM missions**.
- LiFE campaigns scaled in 1 lakh+ schools and colleges.
- INDCs updated to include **45% emissions intensity cut**.

Conclusion

Low-carbon growth must anchor India's **development-climate alignment** in the coming decades.

3. Pollution: Air, Water, Soil — CPCB Reports, NCAP

Quote

"What we breathe and drink today decides who we become tomorrow."

Intro

Through the **National Clean Air Programme**, **Namami Gange**, and **Soil Health Cards**, India is tackling pollution in a mission mode—aligning with a **"right to life is a right to clean environment"** vision.

How should the right to a clean environment be ensured?



Examples

- **NCAP cities showed 25–30% PM2.5 reduction** in 5 years.
- 180+ sewerage projects launched under **Namami Gange**.

- Soil health card scheme distributed **23 crore+ cards**.

Conclusion

Pollution control needs **decentralised monitoring and behavioural change** for deep-rooted impact.

4. EIA, CRZ Regulations, Eco-Sensitive Zones

Quote

"Environment regulation is not anti-growth—it is pro-survival."

Intro

India's **EIA notifications, CRZ rules, and eco-zonal buffers** reflect a calibrated approach to development—aiming for a **"green clearance, not green compromise"** philosophy in project governance.

Choose environmental integrity over compromise.



Examples

- Revised **CRZ norms** enabled coastal tourism with ecological safeguards.
- Online **PARIVESH portal** ensured faster EIA clearances with scrutiny.
- Over **200+ projects** modified based on ESZ impact assessments.

Conclusion

Transparent, science-led EIAs must become the norm, not the exception.

5. Role of Tribunals: NGT, Forest Rights Act

Quote

"Justice delayed in ecology is extinction in slow motion."

Intro

The **National Green Tribunal** and **Forest Rights Act** have emerged as critical institutions in balancing ecology with equity grounding India's vision of **"Green Governance with Tribal Inclusion."**

Examples

- NGT stayed illegal mining near **critical elephant corridors**.
- FRA recognised **1.8 million tribal land titles** with livelihood security.
- NGT fined several states for **solid waste non-compliance**.

Conclusion

Strengthening institutional capacity ensures **environmental justice reaches the last forest-dweller.**

6. Forest Cover Reports, CAMPA Funds

Quote

"Forests are not just carbon sinks—they are cultural lifelines."

Intro

India's forest conservation efforts via **State of Forest Reports, CAMPA Funds**, and afforestation schemes—reflect a "**green GDP**" approach to balancing development and natural wealth.

Examples

- **24.6% of India's area** under forest as per latest report.
- ₹60,000+ crore allocated under **CAMPA** for compensatory afforestation.
- Urban forests developed under **Nagar Van Yojana**.

Conclusion

Ecological restoration must focus on **quality of green cover and local livelihoods**, not just numbers.



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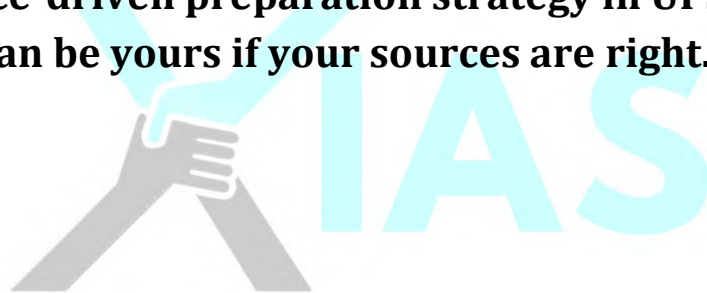
"The difference between a topper and an average aspirant is not effort it's direction."

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14. Who among the following rulers in ancient India had assumed the titles 'Mattavilasa', 'Vichitrachitta' and 'Udambhara'?

- (a) Mahendravarmam I
(b) Simhavishnu
(c) Narasimhavarmam I
(d) Simhavarmam

XIAS
LEVEL-1 RTS
class notes
X lecture

Mahendravarmam I was a follower of Jainism in the early part of his career. He was converted to Saivism by the influence of the Saiva saint, Thirunavukarasar alias Appar. He built a Siva temple at Tiruvadi. He assumed a number of titles like Gunabhara, Suryasandha, Chettakani (builder of temples) Chitrakarapuli, Vichitrachitta and Mattavilasa.

He ruled from Tamralipti (port @ BoBengal) and Amaravati to Burma, and Indonesia. The ports of south India sent ships to Tenasserim, Trang, Malacca, and Java.

The ancient capital of Thailand was named after Ayodhya.

He performed various Vedic sacrifices, including the Ashvamedha.

A later group of Pallava rulers, Mahendra-varman I (600-630) was. He was a contemporary of Thanesar and curiously enough was also a dramatist and poet, of some being the author of a play 'Mattavilasa-prahasana' (The Delight of the

It was during his reign that some of the finest rock-cut Pallava temples, including the famous temples at Mahabalipuram. Mahendra-varman began

Jaina but was converted to Shaivism by the saint Appar. Mahendra-varman's

ty was Pulakeshin II.

varman swept right into the capital of Badami and his occupation of the city

claim to the title of 'Vatapikonda', 'the Conqueror of Vatapi'.

varman's play 'Mattavilasa' was well-known and frequently performed by the actors of

→ RTS LEVEL-2

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13. The irrigation device called 'Araghatta' was

- (a) a water bag made of leather pulled over a pulley
(b) a large wheel with earthen pots tied to the outer ends of its spokes
(c) a larger earthen pot driven by bullocks
(d) a large water bucket pulled up by rope directly by hand

Whether the Persian wheel was in use in early medieval Rajasthan is debated, and hinges on the interpretation of the term 'araghatta'. The key issue is whether the reference is to the Persian wheel or to the *noria*. The *noria* is a wheel which has pots or buckets attached to its rim without a chain for carrying the pots, or a gear mechanism to ensure continuous flow of water. It could only be used to draw water from close to the surface or from a river.



→ Explained in details in BTS class (LEVEL-2)

The Persian wheel, on the other hand, had gears and a chain to carry the pots and was associated with a well. 'araghatta' seems to have been different from an ordinary well (*dhimada*) or a step well (*vapi*). UPSC PYQ.

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6. Consider the following statements :

I. India has joined the Minerals Security Partnership as a member.

II. India is a resource-rich country in all the 30 critical minerals that it has identified.

III. The Parliament in 2023 has amended the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 empowering the Central Government to exclusively auction mining lease and composite license for certain critical minerals.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only (b) II and III only
(c) I and III only (d) I, II and III

MINERALS SECURITY PARTNERSHIP FINANCE NETWORK

Recent Update: India joined the US-led Minerals Security Partnership (MSP) Finance Network to secure sustainable critical mineral supply chains.

About:

- Global Collaboration: Joint financing body for critical mineral projects worldwide.
- Objectives: Strengthen Indo-Pacific and European cooperation for sustainable supply chains.
- Critical Minerals: Includes lithium, cobalt, nickel, and rare earth elements crucial for modern technologies.

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CURRENT
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Magazine

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9. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

Circular economy reduces the emissions of greenhouse gases.

Statement II :

Circular economy reduces the use of raw materials as inputs.

Statement III :

Circular economy reduces wastage in the production process.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I
(b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I
(c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I
(d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

XIAS
Current X-press
Magazine

VOLUNTARY VEHICLE MODERNIZATION PROGRAM

Recent Update: Union Ministry of Road Transport and Highways launched the Vehicle Scrapping Policy

to promote a circular economy in the automotive sector.

About:

- Circular Economy: Aims to reduce raw material consumption and encourage recycling.
- Scrappage Certificate: Provided to owners of unfit vehicles to avail discounts on new purchases.
- Incentives: Discounts of up to 3% for commercial vehicles and 1.5% for passenger vehicles on ex-showroom prices.

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83. Consider the following space missions :

- I. Axiom-4
II. SpaDeX
III. Gaganyaan

How many of the space missions given above encourage and support micro-gravity research?

- (a) Only one (b) Only two
(c) All the three (d) None

GAGANYAAN MISSION

Recent Update: ISRO has selected Gaganyaan astronauts to travel to the International Space Station (ISS) on the Axiom-4 mission, scheduled for October 2024. The mission will be a collaboration with NASA and Axiom Space, utilizing SpaceX's Dragon spacecraft.

About:

- Mission Details: The astronauts will undergo training in the US before the mission.
- Collaboration: India's space program cooperates with NASA and Axiom Space.
- Gaganyaan: India's first human space mission is expected post-2025, after successful uncrewed missions.

AXIOM MISSION 4 (AX-4)

Recent Update: Shubhanshu Shukla and Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair Selected for Axiom-4 mission.

About:

- AX-4: Fourth private astronaut mission to the International Space Station (ISS).
- Duration: 14 days.
- Launch Provider: SpaceX.

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48. With reference to monoclonal antibodies, often mentioned in news, consider the following statements :

- I. They are man-made proteins.
- II. They stimulate immunological function due to their ability to bind to specific antigens.
- III. They are used in treating viral infections like that of Nipah virus.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only
- (b) II and III only
- (c) I and III only
- (d) I, II and III

MONOCLONAL ANTIBODIES

Recent Update: Monoclonal antibodies (mAbs) continue to be widely used in diagnostics, treatments, and cell analysis, offering targeted therapies for diseases like cancer and autoimmune disorders.

About:

- Monoclonal antibodies (mAbs) are lab-made proteins designed to mimic natural antibodies.
- Antibodies are part of the immune system, targeting and destroying foreign materials (antigens).
- Key applications include:
 1. Diagnostics (e.g., ELISA),
 2. Treating diseases such as cancer, infections, and autoimmune disorders,
 3. Cell analysis in blood/tissue using fluorescent tags.

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24. Consider the following statements about turmeric during the year 2022-23 :

- I. India is the largest producer and exporter of turmeric in the world.
- II. More than 30 varieties of turmeric are grown in India.
- III. Maharashtra, Telangana, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu are major turmeric producing States in India.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only
- (b) II and III only
- (c) I and III only
- (d) I, II and III

NATIONAL TURMERIC BOARD ESTABLISHED

Recent Update: The National Turmeric Board has been launched to support turmeric production and export.

About:

- Objectives: Farmer welfare, R&D, export promotion, quality control.
- India's Dominance: Produces 70% of the world's turmeric.
- Key Regions: Maharashtra, Telangana, Meghalaya.

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96. Which organization has enacted the Nature Restoration Law (NRL) to tackle climate change and biodiversity loss?

- (a) The European Union
- (b) The World Bank
- (c) The Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development
- (d) The Food and Agriculture Organization

EU NATURE RESTORATION LAW

Recent Update: The EU Nature Restoration Law has come into force.

About:

- First continent-wide legislation for nature restoration.
- Targets to restore 20% of degraded ecosystems by 2030, and 100% by 2050.
- Member States must prepare National Restoration Plans by 1st September 2026.
- Legally binding targets:
 - 30% of terrestrial, coastal, freshwater, and marine ecosystems to be restored by 2030.
 - 25,000 km of rivers to be restored to free-flowing status by 2030.
 - Plant three billion trees by 2030.

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30. Consider the following statements about the Rashtriya Gokul Mission :

- I. It is important for the upliftment of rural poor as majority of low producing indigenous animals are with small and marginal farmers and landless labourers.
- II. It was initiated to promote indigenous cattle and buffalo rearing and conservation in a scientific and holistic manner.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

RASHTRIYA GOKUL MISSION

Recent Update:

The Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying highlighted the Rashtriya Gokul Mission (RGM) for indigenous bovine conservation and milk production.

About:

- RGM was launched in 2014 as part of the Rashtriya Pashudhan Vikas Yojna with a budget of Rs. 1400 crore (2021-2026).
- Aims to conserve indigenous bovine breeds like Punganur for climate resilience and high-quality milk production.
- Focuses on increasing genetic diversity, supporting Artificial Insemination (AI), and conservation efforts.
- Introduces National Digital Livestock Mission to enhance data management and services.

88. Consider the following statements :

- I. If any question arises as to whether a Member of the House of the People has become subject to disqualification under the 10th Schedule, the President's decision in accordance with the opinion of the Council of Union Ministers shall be final.
- II. There is no mention of the word 'political party' in the Constitution of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

POWERS OF SPEAKER

- The Speaker, elected by a simple majority, has a key constitutional role, including overseeing the House, casting votes, and dealing with member disqualification.
- The Speaker has vast powers in conducting the House, deciding on questions, expunging remarks, and ensuring impartiality in procedures.
- The Speaker's casting vote resolves tie votes, typically favoring the government.

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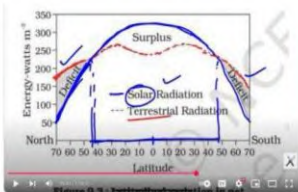
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29. Consider the following statements :

- I. Without the atmosphere, temperature would be well below freezing point everywhere on the Earth's surface.
- II. Heat absorbed and trapped by the atmosphere maintains our planet's average temperature.
- III. Atmosphere's gases, like carbon dioxide, are particularly good at absorbing and trapping radiation.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and III only
- (b) I and II only
- (c) I, II and III
- (d) II and III only



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30. Consider the following statements about the Rashtriya Gokul Mission

- I. It is important for the upliftment of rural poor as majority of low producing indigenous animals are with small and marginal farmers and landless labourers.
- II. It was initiated to promote indigenous cattle and bullock rearing and conservation in a scientific and holistic manner.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

RASHTRIYA GOKUL MISSION

Recent Update: The Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying highlighted the Rashtriya Gokul Mission (RGM) for indigenous bovine conservation and milk production.

About:

- RGM was launched in 2014 as part of the Rashtriya Pashuudhan Vikas Yojna with a budget of Rs. 1000 crore (2014-2020).
- Aims to conserve indigenous bovine breeds like Punganur for climate resilience and high-quality milk production.
- Focuses on genetic improvement, supporting Artificial Insemination (AI), and conservation efforts.
- Introduces National Digital Livestock Mission to enhance data management and services.

38. Consider the following statements :

- I. If any question arises as to whether a Member of the House of the People has become subject to disqualification under the 10th Schedule, the President's decision in accordance with the opinion of the Council of Union Ministers shall be final.
- II. There is no mention of the word 'political party' in the Constitution of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

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84. With reference to India's defence, consider the following pairs :

Aircraft type	Description
I. Dornier-228	: Maritime patrol aircraft
II. IL-76	: Supersonic combat aircraft
III. C-17 Globemaster III	: Military transport aircraft

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All the three
- (d) None

ZORAWAR LIGHT TANK

Recent Update: The DRDO successfully completed the first phase of developmental field trials for the Zorawar Light Tank, designed for high-altitude deployment, especially in Ladakh.

About:

- Tested in desert terrain, met all performance goals.
- Developed by CVRDE and L&T.
- Weights 25 tonnes, highly mobile and versatile.
- Can be transported by C-17 aircraft.
- Integrates technologies like unmanned systems and loitering munition.

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27. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

In January, in the Northern Hemisphere, the isotherms bend equatorward while crossing the landmasses, and poleward while crossing the oceans.

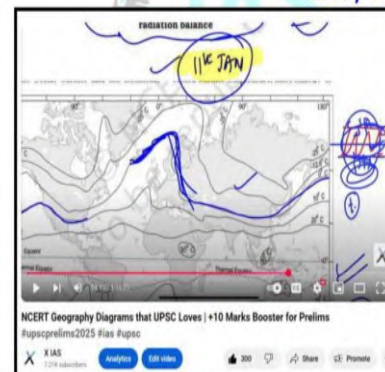
Statement II :

In January, the air over the oceans is warmer than that over the landmasses in the Northern Hemisphere.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
- (b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
- (c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
- (d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

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20. Consider the following statements in respect of the Non-Cooperation Movement :

- I. The Congress declared the attainment of 'Swaraj' by all legitimate and peaceful means to be its objective.
- II. It was to be implemented in stages with civil disobedience and non-payment of taxes for the next stage only if 'Swaraj' did not come within a year and the Government resorted to repression.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

September 1920 At a **special session in Calcutta** the Congress approved a non-cooperation programme till the Panch and Khilafat wrongs were removed and swraj was established. The programme was to include—

- boycott of government schools and colleges;
- boycott of law courts and dispensation of justice through panchayats instead;
- boycott of legislative councils (there were some differences over this as some leaders like C.R. Das were not willing to include a boycott of councils, but bowed to Congress discipline; these leaders boycotted elections held in November 1920 and the majority of the voters too stayed away);
- boycott of foreign cloth and use of khadi instead; also practice of hand-spinning to be done;
- **renunciation of government honours and titles;**
- **refusal to include mass civil disobedience including resignation from government service, and acceptance of arrest.**

During the Congress, the participants were supposed to work for Hindu-Muslim unity and for removal of untouchability, all the time remaining non-violent.

December 1920 At the **Haripur session** of the Indian National Congress—

- (i) The programme of non-cooperation was endorsed.
- (ii) An important change **was made in the Congress creed now aimed at lifting the attainment of self-government as its goal.** The Congress decided to have the attainment of swraj through **peaceful and legitimate means**, thus committing itself to **non-violence** and **constitutional means**.

(iii) Local level preparatory changes were made: a **congress working committee (CWC) of 15 members** was set up to lead the Congress from now onwards; **provincial congress committees** on **linguistic basis were organised**.

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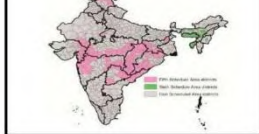
56. Consider the following statements :

- I. With reference to the Constitution of India, if an area in a State is declared as Scheduled Area under the Fifth Schedule
- II. the State Government loses its executive power in such area and a local body assumes total administration
- III. the Union Government can take over the total administration of such area under certain circumstances on the recommendations of the Governor

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

- 10 states have notified Fifth Schedule areas, covering districts in Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha, Rajasthan, and Telangana.



PESA Act, 2006

Recent Update: A recent study has found that providing political representation and decision-making power to tribal populations through acts like PESA has supported forest conservation in India's Scheduled Areas.

About:

The PESA Act, enacted on 24th December 1996, aims to ensure self-governance for people in tribal areas (Scheduled Areas) through traditional village assemblies, or Gram Sabhas, a variety of Panchayat provisions to tribal areas in Fifth Schedule states.

Legislation:

- The Act defines Scheduled Areas as those under Article 243(i), which applies to areas and tribes in states other than Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram.
- Scheduled Areas are those notified by the President as Government of India.

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56. Which one of the following launched the **Nature Solutions Finance Hub for Asia and the Pacific?**

- (a) The Asian Development Bank (ADB)
- (b) The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)
- (c) The New Development Bank (NDB)
- (d) The International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)

ASIA-PACIFIC CLIMATE REPORT 2024

Recent Update: The Asian Development Bank (ADB) highlighted alarming economic impacts of climate change on the Asia-Pacific region in the 2024 report.

About:

- **Economic Impact:** APAC could face a 17% GDP reduction by 2070 under high emissions scenarios.
- **Country-specific Risks:**
 - India: 24.7% GDP decline by 2070.
 - Bangladesh: 30.5% GDP loss.
 - Vietnam: 30.2% reduction.
 - Indonesia: 26.8% decline.
- **Long-term Projections:** Potential 41% GDP loss by 2100.

18 of 40

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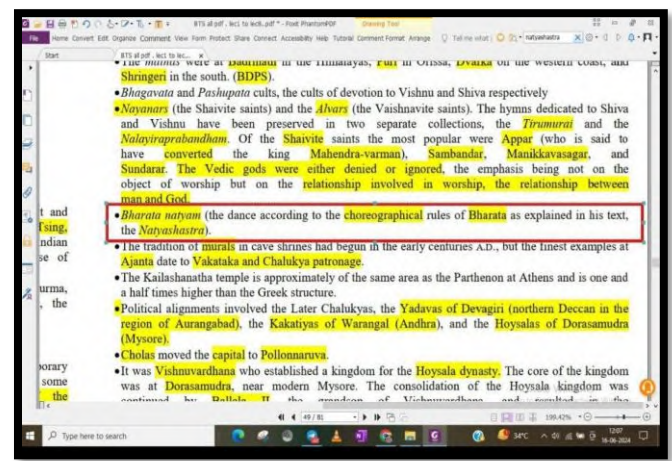
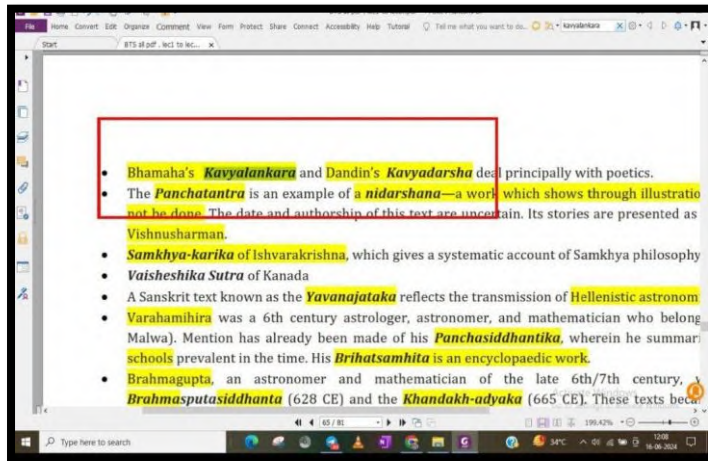
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33 Which one of the following is a work attributed to playwright Bhasa?

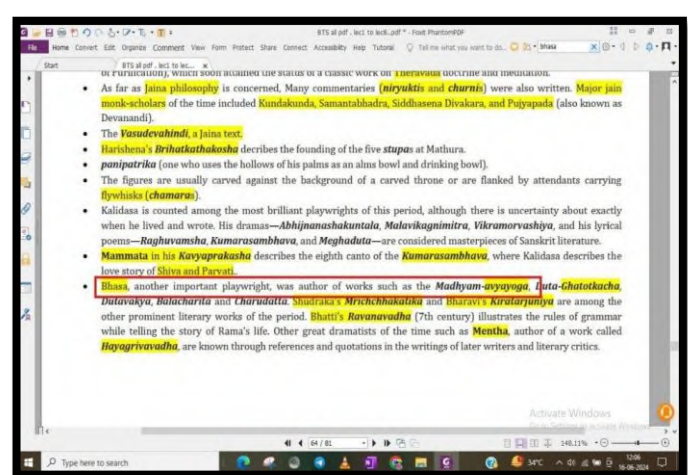
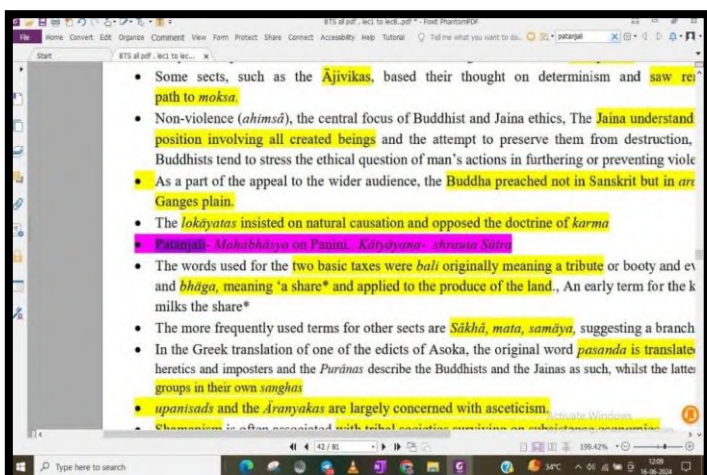
(a) ~~Kavyalankara~~ *Swapaamsha*

(b) *Natyashastra* ~~X~~

(c) *Madhyama-vyayoga* ~~X~~ *Playwright*

(d) *Mahabhashya* ~~X~~ *Buddhist*

Rabarijati

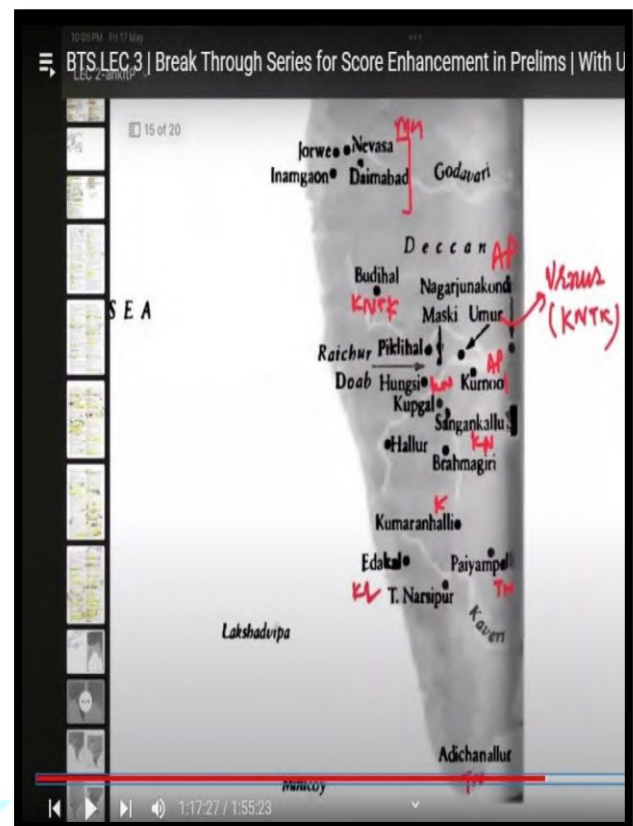


55. Consider the following information :

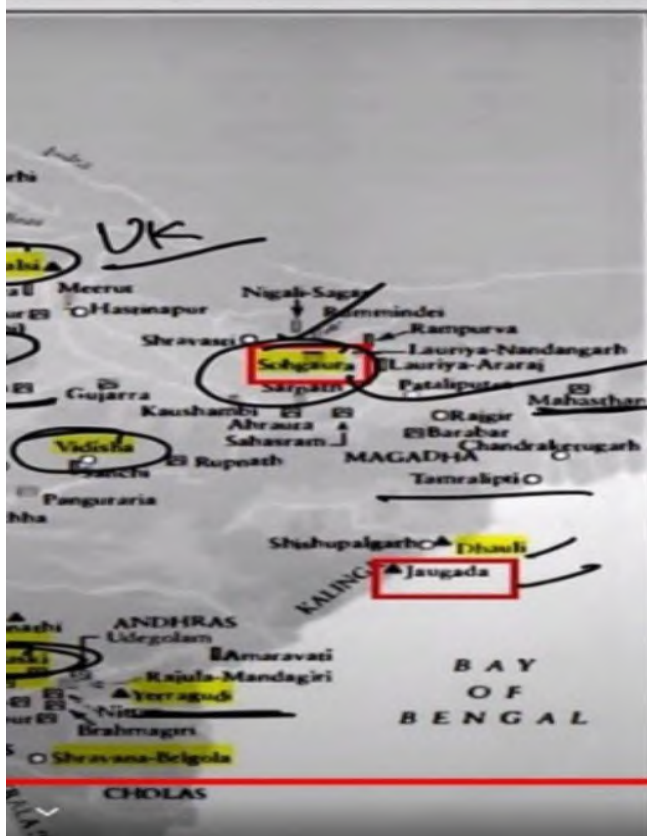
Archaeological Site	State	Description
1. Chandraketugarh	Odisha	Trading Port town
2. Inamgaon	Maharashtra	Chalcolithic site
3. Mangadu	Kerala	Megalithic site
4. Salihundam	Andhra Pradesh	Rock-cut cave shrines

In which of the above rows is the given information correctly matched ?

- (a) 1 and 2
 (b) 2 and 3
 (c) 3 and 4
 (d) 1 and 4



Questions in Prelims 2024 : Score Enhance...



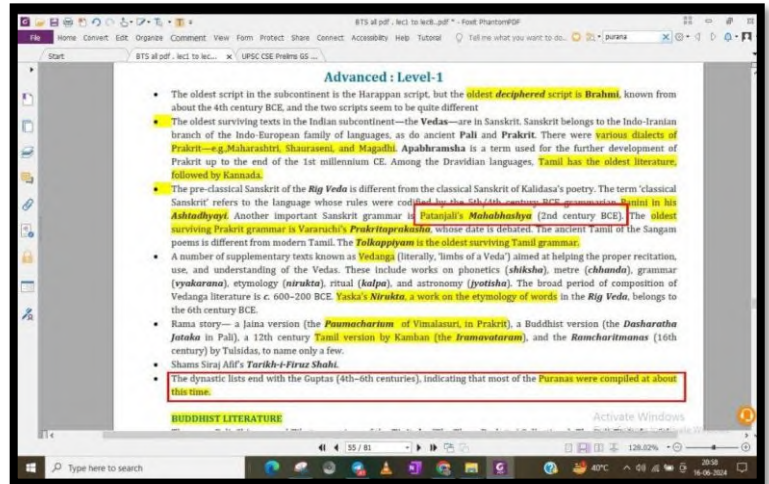
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 Mangadu
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58. Consider the following statements :

1. There are no parables in Upanishads.
2. Upanishads were composed earlier than the Puranas.

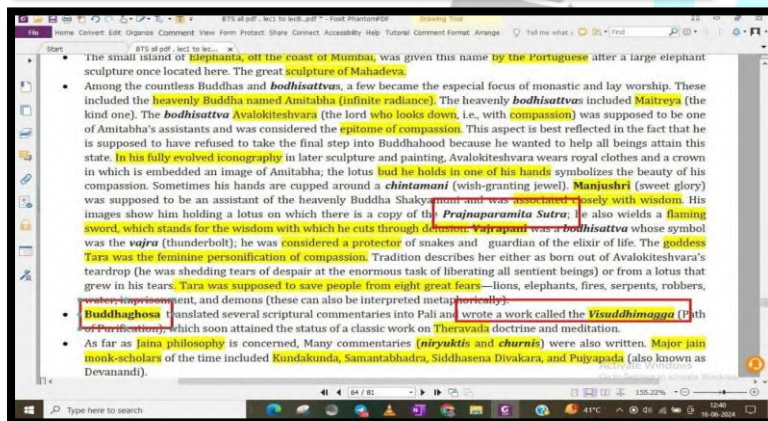
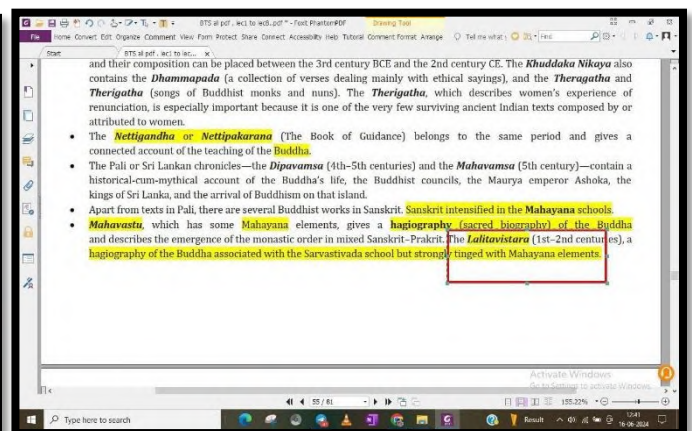
Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2



Sanghabhuti, an Indian Buddhist monk, who travelled to China at the end of the fourth century AD, was the author of a commentary on :

- (a) Prajnaparamita Sutra
- (b) Visuddhimagga
- (c) Sarvastivada Vinaya
- (d) Lalitavistara



With reference to ancient India, Gautama Buddha was generally known by which of the following epithets?

1. Nayaputta
2. Shakyamuni
3. Tathagata

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None of the above are epithets of Gautama Buddha

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